

Design Document: Connecting Prototypes to Lecture Concepts and Client Requirements

Client: AIDS Program South Saskatchewan (apss)

Introduction:

This document will connect the design prototypes discussed for the AIDS Program South Saskatchewan (apss) with the learning concepts in ENSE 271 lectures and the Client needs.

The client is a community-based organization which is operating since 1886, working to prevent HIV/ AIDS. They also provide the needle exchange services and support the affected people in Saskatchewan, Canada. The client wanted us to redesign their main website that makes user friendly experience, engaging and interactive content, research accessible, easier navigating hotlinks, communicating.

With the analysis of client needs noted in Empathy map and brainstorming the design idea in group representing through Site Map and Lo-Fi Design prototypes. We will show exactly how these prototypes fix the clients problems with what we learned in the lectures.

Discussion of Lecture Concepts and Prototype Connections

(Bijay, Renzo, Juanna, Olexiy)

1. The Psychopathology of Everyday Things

On this topic of interest, we learn that good design requires both discoverability and understandability toward their users.

Discoverability: Our first meet with client helps us to discover their major points of interest towards What they want for design approach. The in-class note in **Empathy Map** in different section: **What does the client SAY, What does the client THINK, What does the client DO, What does the client FEEL, Pain Feelings and Gain Feelings** helps all of us to discover the needs. Also, as discovering needs from individual was very different that made us to connect what really user needs and clients require.

Understandability: After discovering the needs, we had to make them understandable through our design process. Then we approach several design approaches by reviewing the actual website. The sitemap and Lo- fi design from individual group member help us to understand what approach will ease the client pain feeling to obtain their needs.

2. The Psychology of Everyday Actions

On this topic of interest, we learn about the **Gulf of Execution and Evaluation**. The gulf of execution asks users (How do we work this?) and the gulf of evaluation asks users (Is this what we wanted?).

Gulf of Execution: The common problems for clients were broken hotlinks, poor visual design, less engaging image and navigation that is making their user hard time to figure out the website. We discovered search bar for easy finding for users, less hotlinks icons and dropdown menus that make 3 click system to navigate for user making them not get lost, instead of using AI generated image we will add the clients real work that is updated reflecting recent works. As a user our design of sitemap and lo fi prototypes make them know what to do while visiting the landing page.

Gulf of Evaluation: As progressing through user friendly website to bridge this gulf some feature of adding feedback, blog section meets the needs for users. The client's work is regarding health aspects having blogs, feedback makes users to obtain validity work and make them engage to their information following on that's what I wanted, (WOW, amazing) being users.

3. An Experimental Approach for Design & Framing the Problem

On this topic of interest, we learn about the **Fast Feedback Cycle: Observe → Frame → Brainstorm → Build**. This cycle progressed to connect why **Empathy Map, Sitemap, Lo-Fi design, User Story Mapping** put the users and client's problem altogether for better designs.

Observe: The Empathy Map was main tool for us where we noted what clients say, think, do feel to picture the problem.

Frame: After observation, we framed the problem into two parts **Pain Feelings** (Website Usability, broken hotlinks, poor visual design, Outdated information, accessibility issue) and **Gain Feelings** (User friendly experience, engaging and interactive content, research access, clear navigating hotlinks, ease of communication). This helped us identify exactly what we need to be fixed.

Brainstorm: After having framed problem, the use of **Affinity diagram** while discussing with each other and combining all our empathy map came up with different idea to approach the problem solving for client. Majorly, what we did here is how as a group move to our design approach through initial brainstorming.

Build: Each group member designing the Lo-Fi design and Sitemap is the last approach for us to be done with the fast feedback cycle. This mainly help us to get different feedback from client to make possible change before going to High-Fi prototyping.

4. Brainstorming Alternatives

On this topic of interest, we learn about **Brainstorming** and **Prototyping**. Brainstorming follows a **Converge** (Help to pick the best of ones) / **Diverge** (create many ideas) pattern. As mentioned above how we used affinity diagram (Mindmapping) to use our idea to connect the relating topics. For example: Our approach of having only 5 to 6 main hotlinks on landing page that has 3-4 dropdown links and that goes to information on the users needs. Prototyping is like a draft version for the design. The individual Sitemap and Lo-Fi design were the prototyping that are simple and easy which make client understand what we are trying to make following the problem solution for clients and users. They let us get feedback early before spending time on colors and graphics and going through High Fi prototyping looks.

Conclusion:

Overall, our observation, frame, & brainstorm for apss client's problem are designed through the theory from ENSE271 (People-Centred Design) lectures.

- The **Empathy Map** helped us to understand the client's pain points by understanding what they Say, Think, Do, and Feel.
- The **SiteMap** helped us to organize the logical structure that bridges the gap between user goals and website actions.
- The **Lo-Fi Design** helped us to test the layout and fix the broken hotlinks, poor visual design, less engaging image and navigation in possible real website.
- The **Storiesonboard** helped us to visualize the user's journey step by step, showing how users move through website for example to find needle exchange, to find locations, to find research, to volunteer or donate. The make design feels real and people centered.

Following the seven fundamental design principle we were able to address the client's core need: a user-friendly website to connects users easily with there information, research, needle exchange.